

Supply Chain and Logistics English

Instructor guide for advanced ESL learners working in supply chain and logistics

Audience: supply-chain managers, planners, buyers, logistics coordinators, warehouse leaders, procurement teams, customs staff, and operations managers

Focus: A supply-chain English curriculum for forecasting, shortages, purchasing, inventory, warehouse operations, logistics delays, supplier performance, customs, risk, and crisis communication.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

Purpose and Course Logic

A supply-chain English curriculum for forecasting, shortages, purchasing, inventory, warehouse operations, logistics delays, supplier performance, customs, risk, and crisis communication.

Core language challenge

Advanced learners do not only need vocabulary. They need the ability to ask which standard applies, who owns the decision, what evidence is sufficient, what risk is being accepted, and how to disagree without sounding vague, defensive, or reckless.

Each module trains a realistic workplace pressure point with role-specific terms, decision language, pushback practice, and bounded decision activities learners can apply to their own work.

Course objectives

- Use supply chain and logistics terminology accurately in meetings, written updates, handoffs, escalations, reviews, and client or stakeholder conversations.
- Turn vague requests into specific questions about evidence, owner, deadline, constraint, risk, and decision rights.
- Push back on unsafe, unsupported, noncompliant, unrealistic, or poorly scoped proposals while preserving professional trust.
- Handle realistic dialogues from the field, including conflict, uncertainty, documentation gaps, customer or stakeholder pressure, and cross-functional disagreement.
- Select language that produces concise workplace outputs: briefing notes, escalation updates, meeting scripts, risk memos, decision records, and follow-up messages.

Instructor Module Plans

Module 1. Demand Planning and Forecast Bias (90 minutes)

Discuss forecast changes without treating estimates as promises.

Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: forecast, forecast bias, demand signal, S&OP.
- Explain the workplace tension: Forecast bias, lead time, capacity, and inventory exposure need review.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Increase production commitments immediately.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a demand-planning exception note.

Customized scenario

Workplace pressure

Sales raises the forecast after a promotion begins.

Increase production commitments immediately.

Forecast bias, lead time, capacity, and inventory exposure need review.

Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.

- Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a demand-planning exception note.

Module 2. Procurement and Supplier Performance (90 minutes)

Challenge supplier promises using evidence and contract language.

Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: purchase order, lead time, OTIF, allocation.
- Explain the workplace tension: Capacity, allocation, purchase order terms, and recovery evidence are unclear.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Accept the promise and update the plan.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a supplier recovery plan.

Customized scenario

Workplace pressure

A supplier misses delivery but promises recovery next week.

Accept the promise and update the plan.

Capacity, allocation, purchase order terms, and recovery evidence are unclear.

Classroom sequence

- Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
- Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
- Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
- Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a supplier recovery plan.

Module 3. Inventory, Safety Stock, and Service Levels (90 minutes)

Explain inventory tradeoffs between service and cash.

Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: safety stock, stockout, service level, SKU.
- Explain the workplace tension: Demand variability, lead time, margin, service level, and stockout risk differ by item.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Cut safety stock by the same percentage.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a inventory segmentation memo.

Customized scenario

Workplace pressure

Finance wants to reduce inventory across all SKUs.

Cut safety stock by the same percentage.

Demand variability, lead time, margin, service level, and stockout risk differ by item.

Classroom sequence

- Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
- Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.

3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a inventory segmentation memo.

Module 4. Warehousing and Fulfillment (90 minutes)

Report warehouse constraints and fulfillment risk.

Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: pick rate, slotting, cycle count, backlog.
- Explain the workplace tension: Slotting, labor, scanner data, training, and error types need diagnosis.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Add overtime until backlog clears.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a fulfillment recovery update.

Customized scenario

Workplace pressure

Orders are late because pick accuracy is falling.

Add overtime until backlog clears.

Slotting, labor, scanner data, training, and error types need diagnosis.

Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a fulfillment recovery update.

Module 5. Freight, Routing, and Carrier Delays (90 minutes)

Communicate transportation risk precisely.

Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: incoterms, carrier, expedite, ETA.
- Explain the workplace tension: Mode, route, cutoff time, expedite cost, and customer promise need a decision.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Blame the carrier and wait.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a freight escalation notice.

Customized scenario

Workplace pressure

A carrier misses pickup before a major customer shipment.

Blame the carrier and wait.

Mode, route, cutoff time, expedite cost, and customer promise need a decision.

Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.

2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a freight escalation notice.

Module 6. Customs, Trade Compliance, and Documentation (90 minutes)

Prevent shipment delays caused by incomplete documents.

Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: HS code, country of origin, commercial invoice, broker.
- Explain the workplace tension: Classification, country of origin, valuation, and document consistency matter.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Ask customs to release it anyway.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a customs hold response.

Customized scenario

Workplace pressure

A shipment is held because the commercial invoice has inconsistent data.

Ask customs to release it anyway.

Classification, country of origin, valuation, and document consistency matter.

Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a customs hold response.

Module 7. Supply Risk and Business Continuity (90 minutes)

Discuss disruptions with contingency and prioritization language.

Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: business continuity, dual sourcing, allocation, constraint.
- Explain the workplace tension: Allocation, alternate sources, inventory position, and customer priority need governance.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Promise no customer impact.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a supply risk brief.

Customized scenario

Workplace pressure

A port strike threatens inbound components.

Promise no customer impact.

Allocation, alternate sources, inventory position, and customer priority need governance.

Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a supply risk brief.

Module 8. Executive S&OP Decisions (90 minutes)

Turn cross-functional disagreement into decisions and assumptions.

Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: S&OP, consensus plan, scenario, owner.
- Explain the workplace tension: The executive team must agree on assumptions, risk, upside, and owners.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Use the most optimistic demand view.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a S&OP decision summary.

Customized scenario

Workplace pressure

Sales, finance, and operations disagree on next quarter's plan.

Use the most optimistic demand view.

The executive team must agree on assumptions, risk, upside, and owners.

Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a S&OP decision summary.

Nomenclature and Jargon

These are classroom working definitions. Learners should adapt wording to their organization's policies, systems, and local regulatory environment.

Demand Planning and Forecast Bias

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
forecast	Forward-looking estimate based on assumptions, trends, constraints, and known risks.	clarify forecast; document forecast	Contrast: forecast should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify forecast and the evidence that supports it.

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
forecast bias	In supply chain and logistics, forecast bias is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to discuss forecast changes without treating estimates as promises.	clarify forecast bias; document forecast bias	Contrast: forecast bias should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify forecast bias and the evidence that supports it.
demand signal	In supply chain and logistics, demand signal is a defined information asset or analytical construct used to measure, explain, or predict an outcome. Use it when teams need to discuss forecast changes without treating estimates as promises.	clarify demand signal; document demand signal	Contrast: demand signal should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify demand signal and the evidence that supports it.
S&OP	In supply chain and logistics, S&OP is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to discuss forecast changes without treating estimates as promises.	clarify S&OP; document S&OP	Contrast: S&OP should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify S&OP and the evidence that supports it.

Procurement and Supplier Performance

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
purchase order	In supply chain and logistics, purchase order is a formal intake or routing mechanism that starts work, seeks a decision, or transfers responsibility. Use it when teams need to challenge supplier promises using evidence and contract language.	clarify purchase order; document purchase order	Contrast: purchase order should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify purchase order and the evidence that supports it.
lead time	In supply chain and logistics, lead time is an operational constraint that affects how much work can be completed, by whom, and by when. Use it when teams need to challenge supplier promises using evidence and contract language.	clarify lead time; document lead time	Contrast: lead time should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify lead time and the evidence that supports it.
OTIF	In supply chain and logistics, OTIF is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to challenge supplier promises using evidence and contract language.	clarify OTIF; document OTIF	Contrast: OTIF should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify OTIF and the evidence that supports it.
allocation	In supply chain and logistics, allocation is an operational constraint that affects how much work can be completed, by whom, and by when. Use it when teams need to challenge supplier promises using evidence and contract language.	clarify allocation; document allocation	Contrast: allocation should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify allocation and the evidence that supports it.

Inventory, Safety Stock, and Service Levels

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
safety stock	In supply chain and logistics, safety stock is a performance or governance dimension that must be protected through defined evidence, thresholds, and accountability. Use it when teams need to explain inventory tradeoffs between service and cash.	clarify safety stock; document safety stock	Contrast: safety stock should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify safety stock and the evidence that supports it.
stockout	In supply chain and logistics, stockout is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to explain inventory tradeoffs between service and cash.	clarify stockout; document stockout	Contrast: stockout should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify stockout and the evidence that supports it.
service level	In supply chain and logistics, service level is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to explain inventory tradeoffs between service and cash.	clarify service level; document service level	Contrast: service level should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify service level and the evidence that supports it.
SKU	In supply chain and logistics, SKU is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to explain inventory tradeoffs between service and cash.	clarify SKU; document SKU	Contrast: SKU should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify SKU and the evidence that supports it.

Warehousing and Fulfillment

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
pick rate	In supply chain and logistics, pick rate is a measurable indicator used to quantify performance, exposure, capacity, quality, or change over time. Use it when teams need to report warehouse constraints and fulfillment risk.	track pick rate; explain a change in pick rate	Contrast: pick rate measures a result or condition; it does not, by itself, prove the cause. Example: Before we act, let us track pick rate by segment and explain what changed.
slotting	In supply chain and logistics, slotting is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to report warehouse constraints and fulfillment risk.	clarify slotting; document slotting	Contrast: slotting should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify slotting and the evidence that supports it.
cycle count	In supply chain and logistics, cycle count is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to report warehouse constraints and fulfillment risk.	clarify cycle count; document cycle count	Contrast: cycle count should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify cycle count and the evidence that supports it.
backlog	Ordered body of work waiting to be refined, prioritized, assigned, or completed.	clarify backlog; document backlog	Contrast: backlog should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify backlog and the evidence that supports it.

Freight, Routing, and Carrier Delays

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
incoterms	In supply chain and logistics, incoterms is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to communicate transportation risk precisely.	clarify incoterms; document incoterms	Contrast: incoterms should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify incoterms and the evidence that supports it.
carrier	In supply chain and logistics, carrier is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to communicate transportation risk precisely.	clarify carrier; document carrier	Contrast: carrier should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify carrier and the evidence that supports it.
expedite	In supply chain and logistics, expedite is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to communicate transportation risk precisely.	clarify expedite; document expedite	Contrast: expedite should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify expedite and the evidence that supports it.
ETA	In supply chain and logistics, ETA is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to communicate transportation risk precisely.	clarify ETA; document ETA	Contrast: ETA should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify ETA and the evidence that supports it.

Customs, Trade Compliance, and Documentation

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
HS code	In supply chain and logistics, HS code is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to prevent shipment delays caused by incomplete documents.	clarify HS code; document HS code	Contrast: HS code should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify HS code and the evidence that supports it.
country of origin	In supply chain and logistics, country of origin is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to prevent shipment delays caused by incomplete documents.	clarify country of origin; document country of origin	Contrast: country of origin should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify country of origin and the evidence that supports it.
commercial invoice	In supply chain and logistics, commercial invoice is a communication or market-facing element that must match evidence, audience, channel, and approval boundaries. Use it when teams need to prevent shipment delays caused by incomplete documents.	clarify commercial invoice; document commercial invoice	Contrast: commercial invoice should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify commercial invoice and the evidence that supports it.
broker	In supply chain and logistics, broker is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to prevent shipment delays caused by incomplete documents.	clarify broker; document broker	Contrast: broker should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify broker and the evidence that supports it.

Supply Risk and Business Continuity

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
business continuity	In supply chain and logistics, business continuity is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to discuss disruptions with contingency and prioritization language.	clarify business continuity; document business continuity	Contrast: business continuity should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify business continuity and the evidence that supports it.
dual sourcing	In supply chain and logistics, dual sourcing is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to discuss disruptions with contingency and prioritization language.	clarify dual sourcing; document dual sourcing	Contrast: dual sourcing should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify dual sourcing and the evidence that supports it.
allocation	In supply chain and logistics, allocation is an operational constraint that affects how much work can be completed, by whom, and by when. Use it when teams need to discuss disruptions with contingency and prioritization language.	clarify allocation; document allocation	Contrast: allocation should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify allocation and the evidence that supports it.
constraint	In supply chain and logistics, constraint is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to discuss disruptions with contingency and prioritization language.	clarify constraint; document constraint	Contrast: constraint should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify constraint and the evidence that supports it.

Executive S&OP Decisions

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
S&OP	In supply chain and logistics, S&OP is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to turn cross-functional disagreement into decisions and assumptions.	clarify S&OP; document S&OP	Contrast: S&OP should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify S&OP and the evidence that supports it.
consensus plan	In supply chain and logistics, consensus plan is a structured course of action that assigns priorities, sequencing, assumptions, and responsible roles. Use it when teams need to turn cross-functional disagreement into decisions and assumptions.	align on the consensus plan; revise the consensus plan	Contrast: consensus plan sets an intended course of action; it is not proof that the work is feasible or approved. Example: Before we revise the consensus plan, we need to test the dependency and resource assumptions.
scenario	In supply chain and logistics, scenario is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to turn cross-functional disagreement into decisions and assumptions.	clarify scenario; document scenario	Contrast: scenario should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify scenario and the evidence that supports it.
owner	Named person or role accountable for a decision, action, deliverable, or risk.	clarify owner; document owner	Contrast: owner should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify owner and the evidence that supports it.

Industry-Specific Meeting Moves

Situation	Useful language
Demand Planning and Forecast Bias	Before we commit, I want to confirm forecast, forecast bias, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If forecast bias, lead time, capacity, and inventory exposure need review., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.
Procurement and Supplier Performance	Before we commit, I want to confirm purchase order, lead time, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If capacity, allocation, purchase order terms, and recovery evidence are unclear., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.
Inventory, Safety Stock, and Service Levels	Before we commit, I want to confirm safety stock, stockout, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If demand variability, lead time, margin, service level, and stockout risk differ by item., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.
Warehousing and Fulfillment	Before we commit, I want to confirm pick rate, slotting, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If slotting, labor, scanner data, training, and error types need diagnosis., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.
Freight, Routing, and Carrier Delays	Before we commit, I want to confirm incoterms, carrier, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If mode, route, cutoff time, expedite cost, and customer promise need a decision., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.
Customs, Trade Compliance, and Documentation	Before we commit, I want to confirm HS code, country of origin, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If classification, country of origin, valuation, and document consistency matter., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.
Supply Risk and Business Continuity	Before we commit, I want to confirm business continuity, dual sourcing, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If allocation, alternate sources, inventory position, and customer priority need governance., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.
Executive S&OP Decisions	Before we commit, I want to confirm S&OP, consensus plan, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If the executive team must agree on assumptions, risk, upside, and owners., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.

High-pressure pushback frames

- I understand the urgency. The risk is that we move faster than the evidence or process supports.
- I am not blocking the goal. I am naming the condition we need before the decision is safe and credible.
- If we accept this risk, we should name the owner, document the assumption, and define the trigger for escalation.
- That may be possible, but not under the current scope, timeline, or approval path.
- Let's separate what we know, what we assume, and what still needs confirmation.

Assessment and Coaching

Performance rubric

Skill	Developing	Proficient	Strong
Terminology	Recognizes terms but uses them loosely.	Uses field terms accurately in context.	Defines terms, connects them to evidence, and explains decision impact.
Pushback	Disagrees vaguely or avoids disagreement.	Names concern with evidence and next step.	Balances urgency, relationship, risk, owner, and decision rights.
Scenario judgment	Focuses on one stakeholder's preference.	Identifies constraint, risk, and process.	Guides the group toward a documented, realistic decision.
Decision communication	Selects language without linking it to the decision.	Chooses language that names facts, owner, and next step.	Distinguishes evidence, tradeoff, authority, and escalation in a decision-ready response.

Source orientation

- Supplier contracts and purchase terms.
- Trade compliance procedures and customs documentation rules.
- Company S&OP, inventory, and logistics policies.
- The learner's own company policies, SOPs, contracts, systems, templates, and approved communication standards.